

Quick Reference Cheat Sheets

Everything you need at a glance. Screenshot these pages, print them out, or keep them on your phone. These are your pocket survival cards for Sweden.

Cheat Sheet #1: Top 25 Must-Know Phrases

If you learn nothing else from this entire book, learn these. These 25 phrases will get you through 90% of situations in Sweden.

Hej! / Hej hej!

/hey/ /hey hey/

Hi! / Hi hi!

Hej da!

/hey D0H/

Goodbye!

Tack / Tack sa mycket

/tahk/ /tahk soh MYH-keh/

Thanks / Thank you so much

Ja / Nej

/yah/ /ney/

Yes / No

Ursäkta

/ur-SHEK-tah/

Excuse me

Förlåt

/fur-LOHT/

Sorry (apology)

Jag förstår inte

/yah fur-STOR IN-teh/

I don't understand

Pratar du engelska?

/PRAH-tar doo ENG-el-ska/

Do you speak English?

Var är...?

/var air/

Where is...?

Hur mycket kostar det?

/hoor MY-keh KOS-tar deh/

How much does it cost?

Kan jag fa..., tack?

/kan yah foh..., tahk/

Can I have..., please?

Jag heter...

/yah HEH-ter/

My name is...

Jag kommer fran...

/yah KOM-er frohn/

I come from...

Jag pratar lite svenska

/yah PRAH-tar LEE-teh SVEN-ska/

I speak a little Swedish

Kan jag betala med kort?

/kan yah beh-TAH-lah med kort/

Can I pay by card?

En kaffe, tack

/en KAH-feh, tahk/

A coffee, please

Kan jag se menyn?

/kan yah seh meh-NYHN/

Can I see the menu?

Kan jag fa notan, tack?

/kan yah foh NOH-tan, tahk/

Can I get the bill, please?

Var är toaletten?

/var air toh-ah-LEH-ten/

Where is the bathroom?

Hjälp!

/yelp/

Help!

Jag mår inte bra

/yah mohr IN-teh brah/

I don't feel well

Skål!

/skohl/

Cheers!

Fint väder idag!

/fint VEH-der ee-DAHG/

Nice weather today!

Det var jättegott!

/deh var YEH-teh-got/

That was really delicious!

Ha det bra!

/hah deh brah/

Take care!

Cheat Sheet #2: Numbers

1–10

1 ett | 2 två | 3 tre | 4 fyra | 5 fem

/eht/ /tvoh/ /treh/ /FYH-rah/ /fem/

One through five

6 sex | 7 sju | 8 åtta | 9 nio | 10 tio

/sex/ /hwoo/ /OH-tah/ /NEE-oh/ /TEE-oh/

Six through ten

11–20

11 elva | 12 tolv | 13 tretton | 14 fjorton | 15 femton

/EL-vah/ /tolv/ /TREH-ton/ /FYOR-ton/ /FEM-ton/

Eleven through fifteen

16 sexton | 17 sjutton | 18 arton | 19 nitton | 20 tjugo

/SEX-ton/ /HWOO-ton/ /AR-ton/ /NI-ton/ /SHOO-goh/

Sixteen through twenty

Bigger Numbers

30 trettio | 40 fyrtio | 50 femtio

/TREH-tee/ /FUR-tee/ /FEM-tee/

Thirty, forty, fifty

60 sextio | 70 sjuttio | 80 åttio

/SEX-tee/ /HWOO-tee/ /OH-tee/

Sixty, seventy, eighty

90 nittio | 100 hundra | 1000 tusen

/NI-tee/ /H00N-drah/ /T00-sen/

Ninety, one hundred, one thousand

Cheat Sheet #3: Days & Months

Swedish doesn't capitalize days or months. A small detail that shows you know what you're doing.

Days of the Week

måndag | tisdag | onsdag

/MOHN-dah/ /TEES-dah/ /OHNS-dah/

Monday | Tuesday | Wednesday

torsdag | fredag

/TORS-dah/ /FRED-dah/

Thursday | Friday

lördag | söndag

/LUR-dah/ /SUN-dah/

Saturday | Sunday

Months

januari | februari | mars | april

/yah-noo-AH-ree/ /feb-roo-AH-ree/ /mahrs/ /ah-PRIL/

January | February | March | April

maj | juni | juli | augusti

/my/ /YOO-nee/ /YOO-lee/ /ow-GUS-tee/

May | June | July | August

september | oktober | november | december

/sep-TEM-ber/ /ok-TOH-ber/ /noh-VEM-ber/ /deh-SEM-ber/

September | October | November | December

Useful Time Words

Idag | Igår | Imorgon

/ee-DAHG/ /ee-GOHR/ /ee-MOR-on/

Today | Yesterday | Tomorrow

Nu | Snart | Senare | Alltid | Aldrig

/noo/ /snahrt/ /SEH-nah-reh/ /AHL-tid/ /AHL-drigr/

Now | Soon | Later | Always | Never

Cheat Sheet #4: Common Signs You'll See

Decode Swedish signs instantly. You'll see these everywhere — on doors, in trains, at shops.

Ingång / Utgång

/IN-gong/ /OOT-gong/

Entrance / Exit

Öppet / Stängt

/UH-pet/ /stengt/

Open / Closed

Drag / Tryck

/drahg/ /tryhk/

Pull / Push

Ledigt / Upptaget

/LEH-digt/ /OOP-tah-get/

Vacant / Occupied (bathrooms)

Förbjudet

/fur-BYOO-det/

Forbidden / Prohibited

Varning

/VAR-ning/

Warning

Ej i funktion / Ur funktion

/ey ee funk-SHOHN/

Out of order

Rea / Rabatt / Extrapris

/REH-ah/ /rah-BAHT/

Sale / Discount / Special price

Kontantfritt

/kon-TAHNT-frit/

Cash-free (no cash accepted)

Rökförbud

/RUHK-fur-bood/

No smoking

Privat / Obehöriga äga ej tillträde

/pree-VAHT/

Private / Unauthorized persons not allowed

Infart / Utfart

/IN-fahrt/ /OOT-fahrt/

Entrance / Exit (for vehicles)

Parkering / P

/par-KEH-ring/

Parking

Gågata

/GOH-gah-tah/

Pedestrian street

Cykelväg

/SYH-keL-vehg/

Bike path (don't walk here!)

Cheat Sheet #5: Emergency Quick Reference

Keep this page bookmarked. Save these numbers in your phone.

IMPORTANT

EMERGENCY: 112 — Police, fire, ambulance (works without SIM card, operators speak English). **HEALTHCARE ADVICE: 1177** — Non-emergency medical help (Vårdguiden). **NON-EMERGENCY POLICE: 114 14** — Reports, questions, non-urgent matters. **DENTAL EMERGENCY:** Search 'akut tandvård' + your city.

Hjälp!

/yelp/

Help!

Ring 112!

/ring EHT-HON-drah-TOLV/

Call 112!

Jag behöver hjälp

/yah beh-HUH-ver yelp/

I need help

Jag behöver en ambulans

/yah beh-HUH-ver en am-boo-LAHNS/

I need an ambulance

Det brinner!

/deh BRIN-er/

There's a fire!

Jag mår inte bra

/yah mohr IN-teh brah/

I don't feel well

Jag har ont i...

/yah har ohnt ee/

I have pain in...

Var är närmaste sjukhus?

/var air NEHR-mas-teh HWOOK-hoos/

Where is the nearest hospital?

Var är närmaste apotek?

/var air NEHR-mas-teh ah-poh-TEK/

Where is the nearest pharmacy?

Jag har tappat mitt pass

/yah har TAH-pat mit pahs/

I've lost my passport

Min telefon är stulen

/min teh-leh-FOHN air ST00-len/

My phone has been stolen

Var är polisstationen?

/var air poh-LEES-stah-SH0H-nen/

Where is the police station?

Var är ambassaden?

/var air am-bah-SAH-den/

Where is the embassy?

Cheat Sheet #6: Pronunciation Quick Guide

The essential rules that make you sound Swedish instead of like you're reading from a phrasebook.

Å = 'oh'

Like the 'o' in 'or'

år (year), gå (walk), båt (boat)

Ä = 'eh'

Like the 'e' in 'bed'

äpple (apple), säga (say)

Ö = 'ur'

Like the 'u' in 'burn'

öl (beer), öra (ear)

J = 'y'

Always like 'yes'

jag (I), juice, ja (yes)

K before e/i/y/ä/ö = 'sh'

Not a hard K

kör (drive), kök (kitchen)

G before e/i/y/ä/ö = 'y'

Soft like 'yes'

göra (do), gärna (gladly)

SJ = 'hwuh'

Soft hushing sound

sju (seven), skjorta (shirt)

Silent G in -ig/-ag

Don't say the final G

jag = 'yah', rolig = 'roo-lee'

RS = 'sh'

R + S merge together

varsågod = 'vah-SHOH-good'

Stress on first syllable

Emphasis at the start

STOCK-holm, GOT-land

CULTURE TIP

This pronunciation guide is your quick refresher. Come back to it whenever you need a reminder. The three most important rules: J is always 'y', the silent G at the end of words, and K/G going soft before certain vowels. Master those three and you're 80% there.

Tack för att du läser!

(Thanks for reading!)

You now have everything you need to survive — and thrive — in Sweden. Remember: Swedes appreciate any effort to speak their language. Don't be afraid to make mistakes. Don't let them switch to English. And most importantly — enjoy the journey.

Lycka till! (Good luck!)

Follow for more Swedish content, lessons, and fun.
This guide is updated regularly — you'll always have the latest version.